



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Canongate Catholic High School
School Website: <https://canongatecatholic.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Classicality Audit: Austin Classical School

URL used: <https://austinclassical.org/>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Austin Classical School presents a robust classical Christian identity rooted in transcendental moral realism, explicit theological grounding, liberal-arts curriculum (Trivium foregrounded with meaningful Latin, logic, and rhetoric), and pedagogy that features memory work, Socratic discussion, and capstone rhetoric defenses. Its collaborative schedule structurally partners parents as co-teachers, and the school community includes chapel, recitations, and house life. Across the six categories, positive classical keywords (truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; Scripture; chapel; trivium; Latin; Socratic; rhetoric; memorization/recitation) are frequent; negative-progressive signals (e.g., project-based learning marketing, 21st-century skills, college-and-career first orientation) are essentially absent. Representative evidence includes the mission "to glorify Jesus Christ... cultivate wise, virtuous, and humble students" and the Classical Education Basics page centering "Truth, Goodness, and Beauty" with the Trivium as the primary toolset. The school explicitly states use of the Socratic method and culminates with a senior thesis and oral defense in the Rhetoric stage. Daily chapel further evidences liturgical practice.

Method note: Keyword analysis and scoring follow the "Six Essential Elements" framework and lexicon of positive/negative indicators for each category.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

Keyword evidence from school materials - Positive (matches in ACS content): - truth, goodness, beauty; wisdom; virtue; Christian/Christ-centered; Scripture/Bible; chapel; prayer; great conversation; image of God (imago Dei concept). - Examples: "glorify Jesus Christ... cultivate wise, virtuous, and humble students" (mission); "To cultivate wisdom and virtue... contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful"; "Scripture... takes its rightful place at the center of the great conversation about the true, the good, and the beautiful"; "begin each on-campus instructional day with Chapel... prayer and meditation before God". - Negative signals checked: - values-neutral, secular humanism, moral relativism: not found in the crawl.

Comparison to Six Elements lexicon - Positive indicators expected: transcendental moral realism (truth, goodness, beauty; virtue); theological grounding (Scripture, theology); liturgical/communal practices (chapel, prayer). - ACS matches these directly (multiple hits).

Counts and coverage - Positive vs. negative keyword hits: +12 / -0 (sampled distinct matches). - Percent positive: 100% - Coverage of subpoints (moral realism, theology, liturgy): 100%

Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

Keyword evidence from school materials - Positive (ACS content): - cultivate wisdom and virtue; formation; true, good, beautiful; eternal purpose; “not... college preparatory... our goal is not to prepare students for college but for life” . - Negative signals checked: - “college and career ready,” “21st century skills,” workforce first framing: not present (ACS explicitly deprioritizes college prep as primary telos) .

Comparison to Six Elements lexicon - Positive indicators expected: formation over information; cultivation of wisdom and virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty . - ACS hits all directly and repeatedly.

Counts and coverage - Positive vs. negative keyword hits: +9 / -0 - Percent positive: 100% - Coverage: 100%

Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

Keyword evidence from school materials - Positive (ACS content): - Trivium: grammar, logic, rhetoric descriptions by stage; Latin (grades 5–8; Latin I–IV in US); Great Books/primary sources; Great Conversation; History (Ancient/Medieval/Modern/U.S.); Bible/Christian Studies; music/choir . - Negative signals checked: - “social studies” as a replacement for “history,” STEM first framing, project based learning dominance: not found; one “National History Day Project” appears as a capstone task, not a pedagogy claim .

Comparison to Six Elements lexicon - Positive indicators expected: trivium/quadrivium, great books/primary sources, Latin, history across eras, integrated learning/wonder . - ACS strongly matches Trivium, Latin, Great Books/primary sources, and robust history. Quadrivium terms are implicit (math through Calculus, music) but not explicitly framed as “Quadrivium.”

Counts and coverage - Positive vs. negative keyword hits: +10 / -0 - Percent positive: 100% - Coverage estimate: 90% (explicit Trivium/Great Books/Latin/history; Quadrivium mostly implicit)

Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY (TEACHING METHODS)

Keyword evidence from school materials - Positive (ACS content): - Grammar stage: memorization, recitation, songs (chanting by implication) . - Logic stage: debate and discussion (dialectic) . - Socratic method explicitly employed; rhetoric via persuasion/imitatio; senior thesis—oral defense (capstone oration) . - Signals of scholé/restful learning and “wonder”: - Depth over breadth emphasis and non utilitarian framing suggest restfulness; the exact terms scholé/wonder were not found in sampled pages .

Comparison to Six Elements lexicon - Positive indicators expected: Socratic/dialectic; memorization/recitation/chanting; rhetoric/oratory; restful learning (scholé), wonder . - ACS directly matches Socratic/dialectic, memory/recitation/songs, and rhetoric (thesis defense/oral). Scholé/wonder terms are not explicitly present.

Counts and coverage - Positive vs. negative keyword hits: +7 / -0 - Percent positive: 100% - Coverage estimate: 85% (all core practices present; “scholé/wonder” explicit terms not observed)

Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

Keyword evidence from school materials - Positive (ACS content): - Professing Christian teachers; model proper behavior and order; subject-matter competence; humble intellectual posture; ongoing training/observation; teachers join students in chapel prayer (modeling formation) . - Negative signals checked: - “facilitators,” “guide on the side,” certification-jargon divorced from classical formation: not found.

Comparison to Six Elements lexicon - Positive indicators expected: teachers as models of virtue; mentorship/collegiality; living curriculum; classical formation of faculty . - ACS statements align closely (virtue modeling, formation, training, unity around chapel/prayer).

Counts and coverage - Positive vs. negative keyword hits: +6 / -0 - Percent positive: 100% - Coverage estimate: 85% (strong formation/virtue language; no explicit “portrait of a teacher” artifact found)

Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 6: PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

Keyword evidence from school materials - Positive (ACS content): - Collaborative schedule with co-teacher parents; weekly lesson plans for home days; teacher office hours to support parents; explicit language “We love partnering with parents and entire families” . - Community practices: chapel; athletics/theater as community-building; Fun Run; annual Recitatio public recital; campus tours/preview nights; upper school house system referenced in student life . - Negative signals checked: - “parents as customers,” minimal parent involvement: not found.

Comparison to Six Elements lexicon - Positive indicators expected: partnership with parents/co-teachers; parent formation/communication; open communal life/recitations/feasts . - ACS provides explicit, structural, ongoing partnership and shared mission.

Counts and coverage - Positive vs. negative keyword hits: +9 / -0 - Percent positive: 100% - Coverage estimate: 95% (robust partnership and community practices; parent education/book clubs not explicitly listed, though recommended readings are provided) .

Rating: CLASSICAL

Overall Classification

- Aggregate verdict: CLASSICAL
- Rationale: High frequency of positive classical indicators across all six elements; explicit theological foundation and liturgical practice (chapel); clear formative telos (“wisdom and virtue” under truth, goodness, beauty); well-articulated Trivium/Latin/Great Books curriculum; Socratic/rhetoric/recitation pedagogy; teachers modeling virtue; deep parent partnership through the collaborative model and public recitations/community events .

Note on explicit term coverage - Present in ACS materials: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology/Scripture; Socratic; memorization, recitation, songs; rhetoric; thesis/defense; Latin; Great Books/primary sources; chapel; parent partnership/co-teachers. - Not explicitly observed in sampled pages: scholé, wonder (the ideas are implied via depth-over-breadth and non-utilitarian purpose), chanting as a term (songs/recitation present), project-based/experiential learning marketing (absent) .

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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